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Wellington & District
LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharéena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbone and Yeoval districts.

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WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Wellington
Boot
Carnival

Friday 10 April
Sunday 12 April

Stuart Town Preservation Society
relaunched
- P5

Is it time for Wellington to reclaim Australia Day organisation? - P2

Swim Pointscore
- P15

Community leadership recognised
- Australia Day 2026



Australia Day Ambassadors Katie, Maggie and Michael Quach with Mayor Josh Black presented the Wellington Citizen of the Year award to Mark Griggs on Sunday evening during the Wellington Australia Day awards ceremony in Cameron Park.

“OUR NATIONAL day is the time for us to come together to reflect, respect and celebrate being part of our nation’s story” – was the beginning of Michael Quach’s address speaking on behalf of the Quach family siblings as Wellington’s Australia Day Ambassadors.

The trio of Michael, Katie and Maggie Quach are the founders of Beyond Best Before, a social-impact enterprise tackling food waste and promoting sustainable living which earned them in 2025 international recognition with a place on the Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia list for Social Impact, highlighting their leadership in sustainability and innovation.

Founded in 2021, Beyond Best Before intercepts surplus stock and near-date grocery items destined for landfill, reselling them at affordable prices through a national e-commerce platform, a flagship store in Sydney, and an emerging wholesale marketplace. Their model reduces waste, saves consumers money, and educates Australians about food sustainability.

Michael Quach told a story of valuing stories that have and continue to shape Australia today.

“From the first nations whose ancestors lived on these lands for tens of thousands of years, to the descendants of settlers, children of migrants and those recently arrived, today we come together to celebrate and share stories about what makes us unique and consider the Australia we aspire to be,” he said.

Michael told of his mother arriving in Australia in 1980 as a Vietnamese refugee from a rural town south of today’s Ho Chi Minh city.

He and his siblings lived in a small street in West Melbourne and tells of their relationship to a Greek family, and shared their stories.

His sister Katie said later that when growing up, “our street was like a family, Greek, Albanian, German, Vietnamese. We shared food, traditions and kindness without thinking twice. That’s the Australian spirit,” she said.

Michael Quach’s Australia Day address is published on page 13.

“What connects us in Australia is our shared desire for unity, safety and prosperity that Australia represents.

“While our experiences may be different, we are shaped by the same quote – that in this country where everyone belongs, everyone’s views, beliefs and contributions are valued.

“Today, I encourage everyone to share a piece of your story, and listen to the stories of others, whether it’s over a slice of cake, a coffee or a VB, because one thing remains true, and that is, we are all an important part in this nation’s ongoing story.”

...Turn to Page 3 for Awards.

Saved for
next
week

Stuart Town, Mumbil and Eucharéena
Australia Day awards and photos next week